

1988

NEWS AT 60

BIG DADDY



BAND AID: Indian soldiers arrive in Male to bail out the beleaguered Abdul Gayoom

◀ REWIND

GUN CONTROL Julio Ribeiro

Julio "Supercop" Ribeiro handed over charge of Punjab Police to K.P.S. Gill to carry on the fight against militancy in the state. Ribeiro came to Punjab in 1986 as an advisor to the Governor on the militancy issue. His reputation as Bombay police commissioner followed him. Rather than bow down to terrorism, Ribeiro promised the terrorists a "bullet for bullet". The result? Between May 1987 and April 1988, 364 terrorists were killed. The supercop was, however, careful—"You have to win over the Sikhs," he said.



1984. He was also the first Indian to win the World Junior Chess Championship in 1987, which was when he was awarded the Padma Shri and the Soviet Land Nehru Award.

FIRST CUT

Viswanathan Anand became India's first chess grandmaster at 18. He was the youngest Indian to win the International Master Title at 15 in

India too played superpower games in its backyard when it quashed the Maldives coup of 1988. Maldivian President Abdul Gayoom, anticipating a third and the most serious coup against his regime (the earlier ones were in 1980 and 1983), appealed to the US, the UK and India for help. On November 3, Rajiv Gandhi responded by sending 1,200 soldiers to help put down the armed Tamil mercenaries who were on the brink of a takeover. More than anything else, it reinforced India's influence in the Indian Ocean.